

masonre

NEW YORK INTERNSHIP

Read this first.

Naomi Plotkin

Touro, New York · Management, focus in Marketing

October 6, 2026 – May 2027

New York office, and the street when the work is there

HOW TO USE THIS

Two documents in one.

Part I is written so you can hand it to Touro for credit. It states the role, the schedule, who supervises you, and the benchmarks we will actually use.

Part II is yours. Read it before October 6. After that, keep it open. The glossary is for downtime. The studio films and the trades are the other half of the job, on the days you are not in the office.

Your channel is Slack. That is how we talk to you, assign work, and take your notes. You will not have your own login for email, CoStar, LoopNet, Salesforce, or GrowthFactor. You learn those by sitting next to the person who has the license.

The case studies live in the brand book. Read it with this, not instead of it.

masonre.com/wp-content/uploads/2026/09/masonre-Brand-Book.pdf

Landlord experience first, then tenant experience. Capital markets is the short section after those two. Your sit-down with Elie is how that section becomes real.

PART I · FOR TOURO

Internship description

Host: masonre, New York. Intern: Naomi Plotkin. Prepared so she can submit it for academic credit.

Position overview

The intern will train inside a retail real estate brokerage and advisory firm. masonre represents landlords and brands in New York, Miami, and Los Angeles. The work is one lifecycle: understand a building, decide who belongs in it, find that brand, and communicate the opportunity.

Naomi is a Management student at Touro in New York, with a focus in Marketing. The internship is built around that focus. She will learn how the firm tells a building's story, how a market is read on foot and in data, and how a brand is found and approached. The aim is a working knowledge of the business, and a clear view of whether this is the career she wants.

She is based in New York for the full term. She works from the New York office and in the field. Florida is a market she will study, and a place she may sit with the team when she is in Hollywood. It is not a second training site.

Schedule

October 6, 2026 through May 2027. Generally two to three days a week, in the office and on the street as the work requires. Days are set with Jeff Jacobson around live assignments, tours, and meetings. Reading, the glossary, studio films, and the trades fill the remaining time.

Supervision

David Abrams, Founder & CEO, is the supervisor for the full term. David directs the plan, reviews the benchmarks, and holds the conversation in May about what she has learned and whether she wants to continue in the field. He also meets with her regularly on Zoom.

Jeff Jacobson, Director, is her day-to-day lead in the New York office. She also trains with Vanessa Chiulli (brand, marketing, and the leasing brochure), Brandon Miller (the retailer), Shane Walsh (film), Elie Mansdorf (capital markets), and Eliot Goldschmidt (CoStar, when she is in Hollywood). Rachael Brook, based in South Beach, joins the October 13–14 onboarding in New York.

Supervisor contact: David Abrams, david@masonre.com, 212.222.1496. On-site lead: Jeff Jacobson, jeff@masonre.com.

Responsibilities

- Learn the firm's vocabulary and use it correctly in conversation and in writing.
- Read the brand book and be able to explain a landlord assignment and a tenant assignment in plain language.
- Walk retail corridors with the team and record what is open, what just leased, and who the neighbors are.
- Sit with the team on GrowthFactor, CoStar, and LoopNet. CoStar is how brokers see the market. LoopNet is how tenants see a listing.
- Learn how a leasing brochure is built: the story, the photographs, the plan, and the tenant the building is for.
- Help look for brands that fit a specific building or a specific rollout.
- Outline an email drip. She does not send client email.
- Write and then perform a short film about the internship. She is on camera. Shane Walsh produces. The team shoots.
- Read the trades each week and brief one trend: what happened, and why it matters to a landlord or a brand.
- Sit with capital markets to see how a building is chosen and bought, not only how it is leased.

Skills and experience gained

- Retail real estate vocabulary and the difference between landlord strategy and tenant strategy.
- How a market is canvassed on foot, then checked in GrowthFactor, CoStar, and LoopNet.
- How a professional leasing story is written and designed.
- How a brand is researched and how outreach is sequenced.
- How to read trade press for trend, not for gossip, across real estate, fashion, and food.
- How to write a 45–60 second script and deliver it on camera.
- A supervised view of capital markets: what makes a retail-driven building worth buying.
- A direct answer, by May 2027, on whether this work is the career she wants.

What success is.

If the term goes to plan, by May 2027 Naomi can do four things without a script in her lap. She can explain who masonre is and what it does. She can explain her role in that work. She can walk a block and say what is missing. She can say whether she wants this career.

Progress is reviewed against the table below. David Abrams reviews it with her at the end of October, at the end of February, and in May. Jeff Jacobson sees the weekly work in Slack as it happens.

TRACK	END OF OCTOBER 2026	END OF FEBRUARY 2027	MAY 2027
The firm	Has read this book and the brand book. Can say who masonre is in a few sentences.	Can tell a landlord story and a tenant story from the brand book without reading them off the page.	Can give the one-minute version on camera: who we are, what we do, and what the intern does.
Vocabulary	Uses the glossary in downtime. Can define the core deal and rent terms correctly.	Uses the terms in her own notes and in conversation with Jeff.	A teammate can hand her a paragraph from a brochure or a trade story and she knows every word that matters.
Landlord strategy	Has started walking with Jeff. Can describe what “merchandising a building” means.	Can write, for one building she has walked, who the landlord is trying to attract and why.	Can stand on a block and connect what she sees to a strategy, not only to a vacant storefront.
Brands	Knows the difference between representing the building and representing the brand.	Has sat with Brandon on how a retailer chooses a street. Has a practice list of brands for one real corridor.	Can explain why a brand fits a building, using the customer, the neighbors, and the rent, not a logo.
The brochure	Has seen a finished masonre brochure and can name its parts.	Has sat with Vanessa through the making of one. Can say what the brochure is arguing.	Can brief a page: the story, the plan, and who it is for.
Mapping	Can canvass a block on foot: open, leased, dark, neighbor.	Has sat in on GrowthFactor, CoStar, and LoopNet. Knows which audience each one speaks to.	Can combine a walk with what the screens show, and say where they disagree.
Outreach	Understands that a drip is a sequence with one ask.	Has outlined one drip in Slack. She has not sent it.	Can defend the order of that sequence: why this person, why this proof, why this ask.
On camera	Delivers a 45–60 second script: who we are, what we do, what her role is.	The script has been revised with Shane and Jeff. A shoot is scheduled.	The first film in “Life as an intern” is finished. She is the person on camera.
Trends	Knows the reading list. Has sent her first weekly note.	A weekly Slack note to Jeff: one story, why it matters, what masonre would do with it.	Can brief a trend out loud and tie it to a landlord or a brand we would actually call.
Capital markets	Has read the capital markets pages in the brand book.	Has sat with Elie on how masonre looks at a building to buy.	Can explain how leasing strategy and an acquisition thesis use the same streets.

The October benchmark that cannot slip: the script. Everything else in the first month supports it. She should not be on camera until the words are right.

Who we are.

masonre is a brokerage and advisory firm. We work in New York, Miami, and Los Angeles. We lead the growth of trophy retail: the buildings, and the brands that make those buildings matter.

The name is masonry. Brick, mortar, craft, a foundation that holds. The standard we use on ourselves is the same one we will use on you: quality over quantity. Fewer things, done properly. Partnership ahead of the transaction. Hustle, and very little ego.

We do two jobs that look different and are the same skill.

For a landlord, we decide who the building is for, merchandise the space, tell that story, and lease it. Sometimes we are in the work before the landlord buys. Sometimes the retail has been dark for years and the job is to change what the street thinks the building is.

For a brand, we learn the customer, pick the streets, and negotiate the stores. A good assignment is a rollout, not a single lucky corner.

Read those two ideas in the brand book until you can say them with examples. Start here:

- **1140 Third Avenue, Upper East Side.** We broke a large retail floor into smaller spaces, put a fitness studio in the lower level off a new 67th Street entrance, and leased Alo, Credo, Bondi Sushi, Madison Reed, Solidcore, and Aesop. Solidcore's number one store in the chain.
- **75 Kenmare, Nolita.** New retail under a residential building. We merchandised it, leased it, and the retail condo sold.
- **101 William, Financial District.** Retail vacant for nearly a decade. The plan was one best-in-class gym for the offices above and the neighborhood. Club Studio, 36,000 square feet, their first New York gym.
- **Oaklyn, Oakland Park.** The brochure was written before the shovel. It had to show a campus, not a list of square feet. Pure Barre, Bondi, Pause, and a set of local and national operators followed.
- **Alo.** A lease on the Upper East Side when the brand had eight stores. Then a South Florida rollout, and the purchase of 100 Lincoln Road for a flagship, an office, and a private gym.
- **Boggi, Peserico, Bondi, SunLife, Reforming Pilates.** Tenant work. Different customers, same muscle: where they should be, and in what order.

You are allowed to know these. They are the firm's public record. If you retell one, retell it accurately, and do not add numbers you did not read.

PART II

Your role.

You are here to learn the business, the way we see a market, who our clients are, and how a client gets found. At the end you should know whether you want this work. That answer is a real outcome of the internship, not a mood we check on the last day.

You will not have a book of business, a license, or a login. You will have Jeff most days you are in, a different teammate when the subject changes, and Slack. You observe, you walk, you write, you ask. You do not speak for masonre, and you do not write to a landlord, a brand, or another broker as if you do.

The first month has one piece of finished work: a script, 45 to 60 seconds, in your voice. It has to carry three ideas. Who masonre is. What we do. What you are here to do. Shane will produce the film. Jeff wants to shoot, and other people on the team will get behind a camera. You are the person in the frame. The series is called Life as an intern. The script comes first.

Before October 6

- Read Part II of this book once, all the way through.
- Read the brand book. Landlord, then tenant, then capital markets.
- Start the glossary. You will not memorize it in a weekend. You will reread it.
- Start the studio films. David will send the watch list as links.
- When Slack is open, say you are in.

October 13 and 14

Onboarding is in person at the New York office. Rachael Brook will be in from South Beach. Jeff will be there. Brandon and Elie will join if they are in the city. The point of those two days is that you meet the people in the same room, hear the plan from more than one voice, and leave knowing who to go to for what.

Rachael Brook is new to the team and based in South Beach. She will be in New York on and off. October 13–14 is the introduction. Dates can move if her travel moves. Jeff will tell you in Slack if they do.

Between those days in the office, David meets with you on Zoom on a regular cadence. That is part of the supervision, not a substitute for the time with Jeff.

PART II · THE TEAM

Learn from all of them.

Everyone here has a lane. Your job in the first months is to spend real time in each lane, not to pick a favorite in week one.

David Abrams, Founder & CEO. Your supervisor. He sets the standard and reviews the benchmarks. You meet with him regularly on Zoom. The May conversation about whether this is your work is with him.

Jeff Jacobson, Director. Your day-to-day in New York. He is in the office the most. He came up as a residential broker, he knows the city as a place people live, and he is the person to learn food from: what a restaurant needs from a space, and why a block works at night as well as at noon. Walk with him.

Vanessa Chiulli, Chief Marketing Officer. Brand, marketing, and design. She is how a leasing brochure actually gets made. Sit with her before you have an opinion about one.

Brandon Miller, Director. He came from the retailer side. Ask him how a brand decides, what a store has to do for the customer, and why a corner that looks good on a map fails the operator.

Shane Walsh, Producer. He produces Life as an intern. You write and you perform. He builds the film. Jeff and others shoot. Nothing is filmed off a draft you are still unhappy with.

Elie Mansdorf, Capital Markets. He shows you the other half of the lifecycle: how we look at a building to buy, not only to lease. This sits beside the eight steps below. Do not skip it.

Eliot Goldschmidt, Director. When you are in Hollywood, you sit with Eliot. He teaches you CoStar. The Florida buildings in the brand book — Design District, Oaklyn, Wynwood, Lincoln Road — are the ones to have read before you do.

Rachael Brook. Based in South Beach, in New York October 13–14 for your onboarding, and in the city at other points during the term. Meet her then. You will see how someone new learns the same firm from the Florida side.

Dena Abrams, Chief Philanthropy Officer. When the schedule allows, hear how she thinks about the neighborhood around a deal. It is part of the firm, and it is part of a full introduction.

PART II · THE PATH

Eight steps, in order.

You will touch all eight during the year. The order is the order you should learn them. October is step 1, the brand book, and the script. Do not jump to filming, and do not jump to outreach, before you can say what the firm does.

01

Real estate vocabulary

The glossary at the back is the list. Read it on the subway, between classes, whenever you would otherwise scroll. In October, mark every term you cannot explain out loud. Ask Jeff the ones that still feel slippery after you have tried. By February the words should show up in your Slack notes without you reaching for this book.

02

Landlord strategy

A landlord assignment starts before a lease draft. Someone has to decide who the building is for. At 1140 Third that meant smaller stores and a fitness use downstairs. At 101 William it meant one gym strong enough to wake up a retail box that had sat empty. At Oaklyn the brochure had to describe a campus before the building existed.

With Jeff, pick one building from the brand book and one block you can actually walk. Write half a page: who lives or works here, what is already on the street, what is missing, and what you would refuse even if they could pay the rent. That is strategy. Square footage is not.

03

Discovering brands

Agency work runs on a list of the right names, kept current. Some of those names are for a building we represent. Some are brands we represent, looking for their next street.

Brandon is the person who will ruin a lazy list. A logo you like is not a reason. He will make you say who the customer is, what they already buy on that block, and whether the operator can survive the rent. Your practice work is a short list for one corridor you have walked. It stays inside the firm until someone else decides it is ready to use.

04

How we communicate — the leasing brochure

The brochure is the argument for the building. It is not a flyer with a floor plan dropped on it. Vanessa will show you how a page earns its place: the line of the neighborhood, the photographs, the plan, the tenant we want, and the thing we are willing to leave out.

Your job is to learn the sequence. Story, then proof, then the ask. When you can describe a brochure that way, you are ready to talk about outreach. Not before.

05

Mapping — walking, GrowthFactor, and CoStar

We canvass. That means feet first. Walk the avenue and the side streets. Note what is open, what is papered, what went dark, who the neighbors are, and what the ground floor is actually doing at 11 a.m. and at 7 p.m. Food is a different business after dark. Jeff will make you see that.

Then the screens, over someone's shoulder. GrowthFactor tells you who visits, where they come from, and what else they go to. CoStar is the broker record: availabilities, comps, ownership, the listing other brokers see. LoopNet is the tenant-facing board. When we post an exclusive, CoStar speaks to brokers and LoopNet speaks to tenants. Same space, two audiences. You do not get a seat of your own. You learn the questions to ask while a teammate drives.

In Hollywood, that CoStar session is with Eliot. Come having already read the Florida projects in the brand book.

06

Email drip campaigns

A drip is a short sequence to one kind of reader, with one reason for writing and one thing we want them to do. It is not a newsletter, and it is not a blast.

You will outline one. Who it is for. The three notes, in order. What proof sits in each note. What the ask is on the last note. You will put that outline in Slack. You will not send it. You do not have an email seat, and a draft is not a campaign until the person who owns the relationship says it is.

07

Life as an intern

You are the subject. Shane produces. Jeff wants more of the team filming, so treat the shoot as a team job, not a favor from one person.

October deliverable, due by October 31: the script, 45 to 60 seconds when read aloud at a normal pace. Time it. Structure it like this.

- One or two sentences: who masonre is.
- One or two sentences: what we do for a landlord and for a brand. Use a real example from the brand book if it helps, and keep it accurate.
- One or two sentences: what you are here to learn between now and May, and what you will have done if the internship works.

Read it to Jeff before you call it done. Shane will tell you what a camera cannot carry. We shoot after the words are settled, not as a way to find the words.

Reading, so you learn the trends

Once a week, on a day you are working, pick one story and send Jeff five lines in Slack. What happened. Who it affects. Whether it matters to a landlord, a brand, or both. What masonre would do with it, even if the answer is nothing.

Read these:

- The Real Deal, Commercial Observer, and Bisnow, for the deals and the markets.
- Crain's New York, for the city around the deals.
- WWD and The Business of Fashion, for the brands that become tenants.
- Eater NY and Grub Street, for restaurants, which are a leasing specialty of their own.

If a better food or fashion source earns a place on the list, Jeff will add it. The habit matters more than the logo on the site.

Beside the eight: capital markets, with Elie

Leasing fills a building. Capital markets asks whether the building should be owned, and by whom. Elie will walk you through how masonre looks at a retail-driven asset: the street, the tenant mix, the rent, and whether the basis makes sense. You are not building a model. You are learning to see that a lease comp and a purchase thesis are the same block of sidewalk, read for two decisions.

Have the capital markets pages of the brand book read before you sit with him. One session is the February benchmark. More than one is better if his calendar allows.

PART II · OCTOBER

The first month, on one page.

- October 6. You start. Slack is live. You know who Jeff is and how to reach him.
- October 13–14. Onboarding at the New York office with Jeff and Rachael Brook. Brandon and Elie if they are around.
- Walk at least once with Jeff before the month ends.
- Brand book: landlord section and tenant section, finished.
- Studio films started. David sends the link list.
- Glossary started, with the terms you miss marked.
- First trend note in Slack.
- October 31. The 45–60 second script, timed, and read to Jeff.

David reviews October against the first column of the benchmark table. If the script is thin, we fix the script before we add work.

From November to May

November. Landlord strategy with Jeff, on a building you can walk. First session with Vanessa on a brochure.

December. Brandon, and a practice brand list for one corridor. Still inside the firm.

January. Mapping. Walking notes, then GrowthFactor, CoStar, and LoopNet over a shoulder. If you are in Hollywood, that CoStar teaching is with Eliot.

February. One drip, outlined in Slack, not sent. A session with Elie. End-of-February review with David.

March. You can brief a trend out loud. The script is in revision with Shane.

April and May. Shoot Life as an intern. Finish the first film. The May review is the benchmarks in the last column, plus your own answer: do you want this work.

The months can slide if a live assignment is the better teacher that week. The benchmarks do not slide. Jeff will say so in Slack when the week changes.

Words to keep rereading.

Retail brokerage, the way we talk. If a definition fights what Jeff tells you on a live deal, the live deal wins, and you update your notes.

The people

Landlord. The owner. We merchandise and lease their retail.

Exclusive. One firm is hired to represent the space or the assignment. We then have something to post and to stand behind.

Credit. Shorthand for a tenant a landlord believes can pay. A famous name and a strong credit are not always the same thing.

The space

Frontage. The width on the street. In retail, width is often worth more than depth.

Corner. Two frontages. Usually the space everyone asks for, and prices that way.

Second generation. A space another tenant already built. Kitchens, floors, and HVAC may be the opportunity.

Dark. Closed. A dark store can still be under lease. Ask.

Lower level. Basement or concourse. It leases when it has its own reason to exist, often its own entrance.

The rent

PSF. Per square foot, almost always per year in the way we quote rent.

NNN / triple net. Tenant pays rent plus taxes, insurance, and common-area costs. Know what "net" is net of.

Tenant. The brand or operator who will occupy the space.

Co-broker. Another broker in the deal. Know which side they are on before you repeat anything they say.

Inline. A store in the run of the block, not a corner and not a pad sitting alone.

Flagship. The store that has to represent the brand, not just ring the register.

White box / vanilla shell. Empty, finished enough to start from, without the last tenant's business built in.

Divisible / demise. Cutting one space into more than one. 1140 Third is the example in our book.

Retail condo. The retail owned separately from the apartments or the office above it. It can be leased, and it can be sold.

Asking vs. taking. What the landlord publishes, and what actually gets signed. Believe comps of signed deals first.

Modified gross. A middle form. Some expenses sit with the landlord, some with the tenant. Read which ones.

CAM. Common area maintenance. The shared-cost bill. It changes the real rent.

Free rent. Months of occupancy before rent starts. It is a concession with a cost.

Percentage rent. Extra rent as a share of sales, usually after a breakpoint. Common in retail, easy to misunderstand.

Possession. When the tenant can take the space.

GLOSSARY, CONTINUED

The deal

Canvass. Walking the market and calling on it. The job before the screen.

Comp. A comparable lease or sale. A comp without the concessions is half a fact.

Lease out. The deal is far enough that lawyers are papering it. Not the same as signed.

Radius. A restriction on the tenant opening another store too close.

Assignment. The tenant transfers the lease. Landlords guard this.

Pro forma. The projection of rent, cost, and outcome. On a landlord job we often build one before the owner closes.

Co-tenancy. Who sits next to whom. Fashion next to fashion is a strategy. So is a gym under apartments.

Food, because Jeff will ask

Venting. How cooking air leaves the building. No vent, no restaurant, unless the use does not need one.

TI. Tenant improvement allowance. Landlord money toward the buildout. It is part of the deal, not a gift beside it.

Escalation. How the rent grows. A percentage a year, or bumps on a schedule.

Term. How long the lease runs.

Rent commencement. When rent starts. It is often not the possession date.

Availability. A space that can be leased. Confirm it. Listings go stale.

LOI. Letter of intent. The business terms, before the lease is drafted.

Use clause. What the tenant is allowed to operate. A bakery and a restaurant are not the same use.

Exclusive use. Protection against a competing use in the same building.

Good guy. A New York guaranty. The guarantor can get off the hook if the tenant pays through a noticed vacancy and gives the space back. Ask Jeff to show you one in a real lease.

Merchandising. Deciding the mix: which uses, which sizes, which names, in which order.

Type 1 / Type 2. Type 1 handles grease from real cooking. Type 2 handles heat and steam. The menu decides which one.

Grease trap. The plumbing a cooking use often has to have. It is a deal issue, not a detail for later.

Second-generation restaurant. Someone already spent the money on the kitchen. Noda, in our book, is the lesson.

The market and the tools

Trade area. Where the customers actually come from. Not the same as the neighborhood's nickname.

Corridor. The stretch of street that trades as one place. Madison, Lincoln Road, the Design District.

Daytime vs. residential. Office workers and people who sleep there are different customers. A block can have one and not the other.

CoStar. The system brokers use. Availabilities, comps, ownership. When we post an exclusive, this is the broker audience.

LoopNet. Where tenants and the public see listings. Same exclusive, different reader.

GrowthFactor. Visit data. Who comes, from where, and what else they frequent. We use it to test a story the walk suggested.

Drip. A short, ordered series of notes to one kind of reader, with one ask.

Cap rate. A price expressed as yield. You will hear it with Elie. You do not need to compute one this year. You need to know it is how buyers talk.

Basis. What an owner has in the deal. It drives what rent they can accept, and whether they will sell.

OM. Offering memorandum. The book for a building that is for sale. Cousin of the leasing brochure, different decision.

Studio, then the trades.

masonre studio is our own record of buildings, openings, and conversations. The point of the series, in the firm's words, is tips for landlords, tenants, and their brokers, and a next generation that knows how the work is actually done. Watch it before you try to be in a film.

David will send the assigned films as links. That list is the assignment. Until it arrives in Slack, start at masonre.com/studio.

While you watch, write down one decision the film is showing. A tenant choice, a street, a way of talking about the building. That note is more useful than a recap of the footage.

The weekly reading list, again, so it sits next to the films:

- The Real Deal
- Commercial Observer
- Bisnow
- Crain's New York
- WWD
- The Business of Fashion
- Eater NY
- Grub Street

One story. Five lines. To Jeff, in Slack. Every week you are working.

By May you should be able to say it in a minute, on your feet. Who we are. What we do. What you did here. And whether you want to keep doing it.

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